

Phoenix Sheppard

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EDUCATION

The University of Michigan

Ann Arbor, MI

B.S.E in Computer Science, Minor in Geospatial Science — GPA: 3.78

May 2028

- **Coursework:** Operating Systems, Computer Networks, Distributed Systems, Web Systems, Data Structures & Algorithms, Data Mining, Computer Organization, Unix Programming, GIS for Earth Science

EXPERIENCE

Palantir- *Software Engineer Intern*

May 2026 - Current

- Spearheaded the replatforming of a real-time activity and edit-history system from the defense to commercial platform, building **full-stack React, Redux, and Java** solutions to surface edit trails & workflow state at scale
- Re-architected the framework as a re-usable, **drop-in infrastructure**, generalizing from defense artifact specific to resource agnostic – so any product team can adopt it, with **AI-agent attribution**, out of the box
- Pioneered the first production launch inside the flagship document application, engineering the **Java backend** that captures the application's document events and pushes them to the activity feed to stream changes to end users
- Architected the complete integration layer – providers, hooks, state, per-document live subscriptions, and read-state tracking – embedding the system through a performance optimized sidebar with zero impact on initial load time
- Re-engineered filtering for one of the platform's most-used services, moving computation to the server and reducing unnecessary network requests by **40%**

Pursuit Markets- *Software Engineer Intern*

May 2025 - August 2025

- Saved **\$70,000+** annually in LlamaIndex and OpenAI API spend by implementing content-hash-based deduplication in a distributed Python backend pipeline, eliminating redundant web extraction calls
- Increased platform data accuracy by **40%** by architecting a Temporal-based distributed data ingestion system in Python, orchestrating concurrent scraping workflows and enforcing 30-day refresh SLAs
- Reduced Amazon ECS container memory consumption by **50%** and saved **\$5,000** annually by implementing asynchronous, streaming uploads to Amazon S3, eliminating full in-memory buffering
- Reduced PostgreSQL query latency by **80%** after migrating **30M** records and removing **15M** redundant rows through schema normalization, indexing optimization, and backend query refactoring
- Resolved **#1 customer pain point** by building dynamic contact-status tracking, monitoring HTTP codes and content changes, contributing to company's highest-revenue month in history

V1 Michigan- *Director*

January 2025 – Present

- Led the University of Michigan's **only pre-idea incubator**, mentoring teams from concept to early traction, with participants going on to achieve **YC acceptances** and secure **\$5M in funding**
- Hosted Y Combinator (YC) events at the University of Michigan **twice**, connecting founders and builders

PROJECTS

Fortnite Item Tracker | *Golang, Gin, PostgreSQL, Docker, Telegram API*

- Built and deployed a Telegram Bot and web app to alert users when tracked cosmetics become available in the Fortnite item shop with mobile push notifications
- Engineered a secure authentication flow using Telegram Login and JSON Web Tokens for session management

Raven | *Python, FastAPI, Celery, Redis, SQLite, Scrapy, Docker*

- Developed a distributed web scraper that identifies and prioritizes high-value links using a custom relevance heuristic powered by the ChatGPT API
- Engineered a scalable, asynchronous architecture leveraging Celery for distributed task queuing and Redis as a message broker, enabling system to handle thousands of concurrent scraping requests

GhostKey | *TypeScript, Plasmio, Ollama, React, Chrome Extension API*

- Developed a Chrome extension with Plasmio and React enabling AI-powered inline text generation across websites, using a keyboard shortcut to trigger context-aware LLM modifications in real time
- Integrated RAG based memory layer with Ollama, OpenAI APIs to provide context-aware text generation and modification, supporting both local and cloud LLM providers

SKILLS

Languages: C++, Python, Golang, JavaScript/TypeScript, Java, SQL, HTML, CSS

Tools: MongoDB, PostgreSQL, SQLite, Docker, Kubernetes, Git, Linux/Unix, Redis, AWS, Node.js, Temporal

Frameworks/Libraries: FastAPI, Gin, Next.js, Redux, React.js, Plasmio, Scikit-Learn, Apache Spark, Hadoop

Security Clearance: Active U.S. Top Secret, NATO Secret